Annotation Guidelines

Aspect-category sentiment (ACSA) for Daraz.lk reviews: Sinhala, Singlish, English and code-mixed text

Purpose

The purpose of this annotation task is to identify the aspects mentioned in customer reviews and assign the appropriate sentiment polarity to each aspect. The annotations will support the development and finalization of the annotation schema for the Aspect-Based Sentiment Analysis (ABSA) dataset.

1. Task Instructions

- Read one customer review at a time.
- Identify the aspects discussed (Section 3) and determine the sentiment polarity (Section 4) expressed toward each aspect.
- A review may contain multiple aspects, and each aspect may have a different polarity. Annotate every identifiable aspect separately.
- If you cannot confidently interpret a review or determine the appropriate label, select **Flag** and add a short comment explaining the issue (Section 4).
- Label only what the review text expresses. Do not use star ratings, personal opinions, or assumptions about who is responsible for a problem.
- Reviews may be written in different languages, scripts, or combinations of languages. Annotate the meaning regardless of the language or script used.
- Refer Decision rules (Section 5) whenever clarification is needed.
- Work independently. Do not ask other annotators or use AI tools to make annotation decisions. Dictionaries may be used to understand unfamiliar words.
- Only the researcher may modify the review text or annotation guidelines. All changes to the guidelines must be recorded in the version log (Section 7).

2. How to annotate

1. Save your own copy of the workbook.
2. Select the appropriate aspect and polarity from the dropdown menu. If you cannot confidently interpret a review, select **Flag** and add a comment. Leave unrelated aspect cells empty.
3. After completing each review, tick the **Check** column. An empty Check column indicates that the review is incomplete.
4. Record approximately how long you spent on the annotation task.
5. Save the completed workbook and send it to the researcher.

3. The aspects and None

Polarity signs:

- + Positive
- - Negative
- ~ Neutral

Aspect (code)	Use when the review comments on...	Examples (real reviews)
Product quality / performance (PQ)	Quality, effectiveness (does it work?), results, durability, and properties of the item itself:(smell, texture, taste, size or fit.)	• "Kisima result ekak na." *No result at all.* **PQ−** • "mekanm supiri." **PQ+** *good.* • "wadak na mekanam." **PQ-** *Not Good*
Price / value (PV)	Price, affordability, offers and discounts, courier charges, value for money.	• 1"Price eka reasonable." *The price is reasonable.* PV+ • "මිල වැඩි හැබැයි Quality" *The price is high, but the quality is great.* PV−, PQ+
Packaging (PK)	How the item was packed; damage/leak blamed on packing.	• "Packing නියමයි." *Packing is excellent.* PK+ • "ඩැමේග් වෙලා packing ekama" *Damaged, the packing itself.* PK−
Delivery (DL)	Speed, delays, arrival time, courier handling, the seller's dispatch time.	• "ඉක්මනට ආවා" *It came quickly.* DL+ • "වෙලාවට එව්වනම් වටිනවා.සති 3ක් ගියා" *It would be worth it if sent on time. 3 weeks went by.* DL−
Customer service Seller/platform service (CS)	Seller behavior, service provided ,communication/reply, wrong or missing items platform support, refunds, app related. *Offers and prices are PV*	• "වැරදි එකක් එවල තිබුනා" *A wrong one had been sent.* CS− • "refund option eka penne na.reply muth na." CS− *No refund option visible and no reply by the admins.* • Thanks, Daraz/Seller CS+

Aspect (code)	Use when the review comments on...	Examples (real reviews)
Authenticity /Trust (AU)	Genuine or fake, original, expiry date, used or opened items. Whether the item matches or not the description provided by the seller (color, size, model, quantity).	• "ෆේක් එකක් නෙවේ" *It is not fake.* AU+ • "The expiry date was far from expiring" AU+ • "photo eke tibuna widiyamai" *Exactly as in the photo.* AU+ • "photo eke tibunat wada bottle eka podi" • *Not like the photo* AU-
Overall / Other (OO)	General opinions not attributable to another aspect/ overall experience *(good, super, best, recommended, love it, disappointed),*	• "Maru" *great* OO+ • Supiri OO+ • Disappoint una OO- • "Highly Recommend" OO+ • "thank you" OO+
None	No aspect-related opinion: a question, thanks only, greeting, unrelated text. r no identifiable aspect	• "Meka kohomada use karanne?" *How do I use this?* None • I don't know if it is original None

Neutral means an aspect is mentioned, but with no clear positive or negative feeling

4. Polarity and flags

Label	Use when	Examples
Positive (+)	The customer is satisfied with that aspect.	"hodai", "fast", "genuine"
Negative (−)	The customer is dissatisfied or reports a problem.	"late", "leaked", "fake"
Neutral (~)	A balanced or factual comment with no clear feeling (ok, average, "madi"), **or** the same aspect is both praised and criticized.	"Quality madi" *Quality is average.* PQ~ "Delivery fast but the courier was rude" DL~
Flag (tick)	Tick **Flag** (and write a short comment) when you are unsure or the review is hard: sarcasm, unclear Singlish, two possible readings.	

5. Decision rules

1. **Only the text counts**. Ignore star ratings, emojis, brand, product knowledge, and your own experience.
2. **One label per aspect** for every aspect mentioned. Different aspects can have different polarities.
3. **General and Specific Wording** (good, super, best, recommended, love it, thanks, disappointed). If the review names an aspect ("good packing", "good product", "good seller"), use that aspect and do not add OO. If it names nothing, use OO.
    - "Thanks" → None (no aspect-related opinion).
    - "Thanks, seller" / "Highly recommend seller" → CS+ [about the seller].
    - "Thanks for the fast delivery" → DL+ (positive delivery opinion).
    - "Thanks for the good packaging" → PK+ (positive packaging opinion).
    - "maru item ekak" → PQ+
    - "Highly recommend" / "maru" / "Thanks" → OO+
    - "Not recommend" → OO−
4. **Price versus quality.**

    "Price is high, but quality is good" is PV− and PQ+.

    "Price is high, not reasonable for this quality" is PV− only.
5. Properties of the item (smell, texture, taste, results, "it works", size, or fit) belong to Product Quality/Performance. There are no sub-aspects in this study.
6. **Damaged or leaking on arrival**.

    If a cause is named, label by cause: weak packaging is PK, courier handling is DL, and a defect in the item (for example, a cap that does not close) is PQ. If no cause is named, label PK− and tick Flag.
7. **Delivery problems are labelled Delivery only**. Do not decide whether the cause was the seller, Daraz, the courier, Dropship, or Daraz Express. A seller's slow dispatch ("took 3 days to pack") is also Delivery.
8. **Not yet used or future.** "Haven't used yet" and "will update later" mean you cannot label the property that has not been judged. So, label it as None. Label only what is already stated.
9. **Neutral** is for "ok", "average", "madi", and factual comments. Mixed feelings about one aspect are Neutral + Mixed.
10. **Sarcasm**. Label the intended meaning and tick Flag.
11. **Questions and requests** are None unless an opinion is also stated.
12. **Emojis only, spam, advertising, copied, or meaningless text** is None and Flag.
13. **Comparisons.**

    "Better than the shop" is positive for that aspect; "not as good as before" is negative.
14. **Language**. Label the meaning in any script. If you do not understand a Singlish word, use the context, tick Flag, and write a comment. Do not skip the review.
15. **When in doubt - Unknown Singlish word**: Choose the best label, tick Flag, and add a comment. Never leave a row empty.

6.Common mistakes

- using the star rating;
- forgetting OO+ for “good / super”;
- labelling general wordings
- deciding who caused a delivery problem;
- labelling an aspect the customer could not judge yet;
- skipping a review because of a Singlish word you do not know.

7. Schema Version

Version	Change
2.0	Second version: 7 aspects plus None 3 polarities + flag 15 decision rules 3-annotators